THE MONSTERS CHANGED. THE FEAR DIDN'T.

105 people. One childhood survey. Two versions of fear.

The dark.
Monsters.
Being trapped.
What if?

Different monsters.
Same fear.

War.
Uncertainty.
Money. Health.
Not being good enough.

43%

45

of 105 people

carried at least one childhood fear into adulthood.

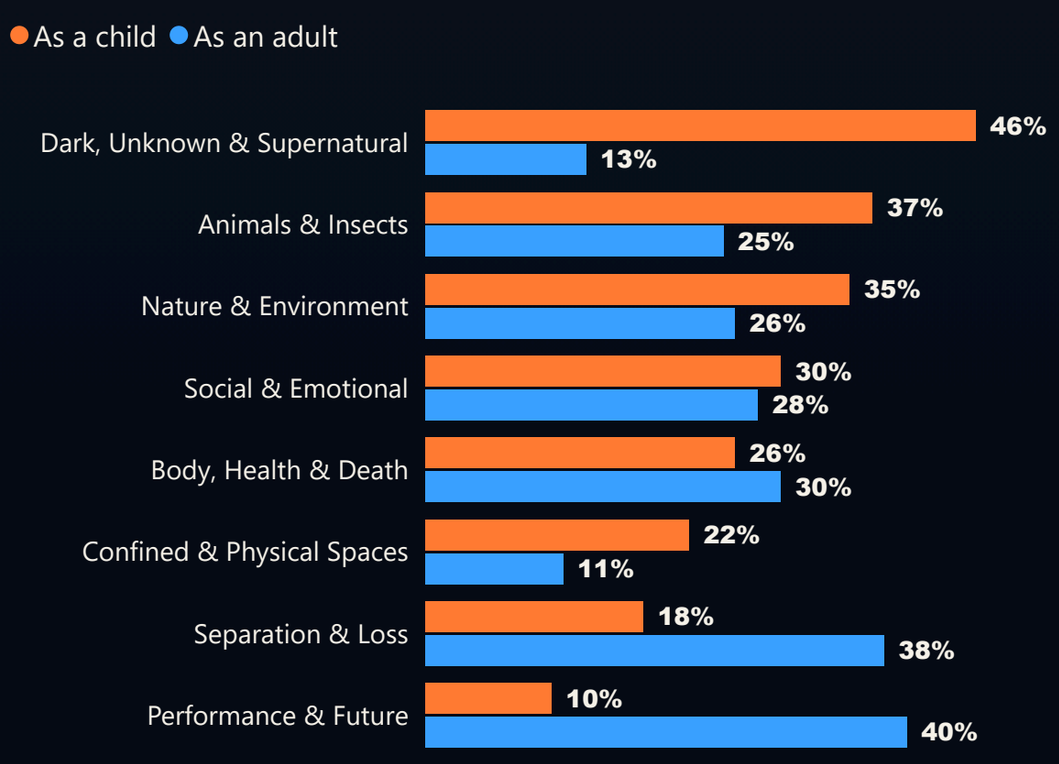
57%

60

of 105 people kept none of their childhood fears

FEARS EVOLVE

Every kind of fear we could point at shrank. Every kind we carry inside grew.
Share of the 105 people naming each category, as a child vs as an adult.



TODAY'S TOP FEARS

What people pick today, but did not pick as children.
Number of people naming each fear today but not in childhood.



WHAT STAYED. WHAT CHANGED.

Childhood fears that still haunt us

Of the people who feared this as a child, how many still do.

Snakes

11 feared it as a child

6 still afraid today

Being trapped

14 feared it as a child

5 still afraid today

Heights

13 feared it as a child

4 still afraid today

New fears in adult life

Things that rarely scared us as kids, but do now.

War

5 feared it as a child

19 fear it now as an adult

Uncertainty about the future

4 feared it as a child

14 fear it now as an adult

Not being good enough

3 feared it as a child

10 fear it now as an adult

Anonymous Fabric Community survey, 27 Sep to 11 Oct 2026, 105 self-selected respondents from 28 countries. Each person named up to 3 childhood fears and up to 3 current fears from the same 75 options. "Still afraid" means the same person named the same fear at both stages. Categories are the survey author's. Source values unchanged; no outside data.